

32.12 KEY LANGUAGE "I WISH"

PRESENT REGRETS

You can express regrets about the present in a similar way to the second conditional by using "I wish."



The snow is amazing!
I wish I knew how to ski.

↑
"Wish" + past
has present meaning.

PAST REGRETS

You can also use "I wish" to express regrets about the past in a similar way to the third conditional.



My camera has no power.
I wish I'd charged the battery.

↑
"Wish" + "had" + past participle
has past meaning.



32.13 ANOTHER WAY TO SAY "I WISH"

PRESENT REGRETS

You can express stronger regrets about the present by using "if only" and the past tense.

These mountains are incredible!
If only I knew how to ski.

PAST REGRETS

You can express stronger regrets about the past by using "if only" with "had" and the past participle.

I really wanted to take pictures.
If only I'd charged the battery.



32.14 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORDS IN EACH SENTENCE

There wasn't much wildlife. I wish I **had seen** / ~~saw~~ more animals!

- 1 I wish we **weren't** / **hadn't been** outdoors right now.
- 2 I think about the trip a lot. I wish I **took** / **had taken** more photos.
- 3 I feel sick. If only I **had eaten** / **ate** fewer of those berries.
- 4 The bus has broken down! If only the driver **had known** / **knew** how to fix it.
- 5 I'm so exhausted! If only I **sleep** / **'d slept** a little more.

